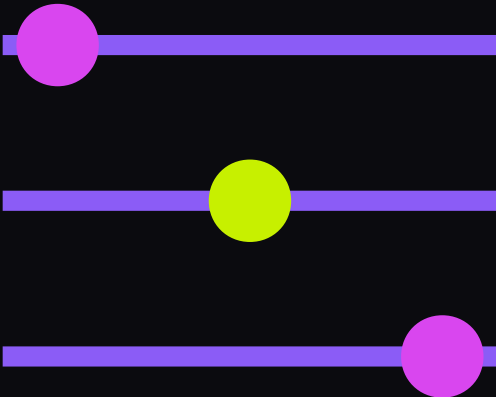


FMC PACKAGE TOOL LICENSE.TMP EXECUTION

Hunts the exact package_info.pl invocation used to execute an attacker-crafted license.tmp on compromised Cisco Secure FMC appliances.

HUNTING QUERY

CONFIDENCE: MEDIUM



DeviceProcessEvents

Campaign-specific artifact

EVIDENCE BEFORE ALERTING

REPORT DATE	STATUS
13 September 2026	Untested implementation sketch
PRIMARY PLATFORM	OPERATIONAL VALUE
Microsoft Defender XDR	9.4 / 10



EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Decision, confidence and evidence boundary.

ASSESSMENT

OPERATIONAL VALUE

9.4

Hunts the exact package_info.pl invocation used to execute an attacker-crafted license.tmp on compromised Cisco Secure FMC appliances.

STATUS

Hunting query

Hunting query - Untested implementation sketch; Confidence Medium.

1primary table

0thresholds

0joins

0secondary rules

Evidence boundary

A result does not prove CVE-2026-20079/CVE-2026-20316 exploitation, root command execution, reverse shell success, Cyclops Blink deployment, or compromise.



BEHAVIOR AND EVIDENCE

Observed facts separated from analytical scope.

MECHANICS

Source-supported fact

- 1 Cisco Talos directly observed `/usr/local/sf/bin/package_info.pl /var/tmp/license.tmp --lsm` in UAT-11823 activity.
- 2 The crafted package established a Netcat-based reverse shell and ran through the installation process as root.
- 3 The same built-in utility was also abused by a ransomware operator for reconnaissance and credential collection.

Detection hypothesis

If an attacker repeats this behavior, process telemetry should show the source-observed command and ancestry. It can be distinguished through the exact execution context plus provenance and adjacent host evidence.

Unconfirmed elements

A result does not prove CVE-2026-20079/CVE-2026-20316 exploitation, root command execution, reverse shell success, Cyclops Blink deployment, or compromise.

Logic: Campaign-specific artifact **ATT&CK:** T1059



TELEMETRY CONTRACT

Collection prerequisites and documented fields.

TELEMETRY

REQUIRED

Defender for Endpoint on the FMC host with Linux process creation and complete ProcessCommandLine capture.

OPTIONAL ENRICHMENT

FMC audit/install logs, file events for license.tmp, parent/root context, Netcat and network telemetry, appliance version and hotfix state.

Fields	Reliability	Use
Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName	Documented	Required for query or triage
FileName, FolderPath	Documented	Required for query or triage
ProcessCommandLine	Documented	Required for query or triage
AccountName	Documented	Required for query or triage
InitiatingProcessFileName	Documented	Required for query or triage
ReportId	Documented	Required for query or triage

Unavailable / excluded

No browser payload, encrypted content, inferred success, rarity score, arbitrary threshold, or undocumented field is used.



PRIMARY KQL

Direct, source-supported conditions with investigable output.

DETECTION

STATUS

Hunting query - Untested implementation sketch

KQL – UNTESTED

```
DeviceProcessEvents
| where ProcessCommandLine contains
    "/usr/local/sf/bin/package_info.pl"
| where ProcessCommandLine contains "/var/tmp/license.tmp"
| where ProcessCommandLine contains "--lsm"
| project Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName, AccountName,
    FileName, FolderPath, ProcessCommandLine, ProcessId,
    InitiatingProcessFileName, InitiatingProcessCommandLine,
    ReportId
| order by Timestamp desc
```

THRESHOLD	WINDOW	JOIN	AGGREGATION	EXECUTION
None	None	None	None	Untested



TRIAGE AND TUNING

Human validation before response.

WORKFLOW

1

Preserve raw event

Retain projected IDs and complete process context.

2

Confirm provenance

Identify user, maintenance path and initiating application.

3

Enrich

FMC audit/install logs, file events for license.tmp, parent/root context, Netcat and network telemetry, appliance version and hotfix state.

4

Scope

Review adjacent endpoint, identity and network evidence.

Expected benign overlap

Legitimate FMC upgrade, hotfix, installation, recovery, or TAC workflows may use the same package utility and license.tmp path. Confirm maintenance records, package provenance, appliance owner, caller, file hash and surrounding process/network activity.

Response boundary

A result does not prove CVE-2026-20079/CVE-2026-20316 exploitation, root command execution, reverse shell success, Cyclops Blink deployment, or compromise.



VALIDATION GATES

Controlled tests and cross-SIEM limits.

QUALITY CONTROL

Validation steps

1. Confirm MDE support and process coverage on the target FMC deployment.
2. Capture one approved package installation and verify exact command-line representation.
3. Search available retention and classify all package_info.pl invocations.
4. Compare hits with FMC maintenance/audit logs and file/network events.

Decision criteria

Success: Approved test/maintenance activity establishes the schema and any unmatched executions retain usable actor, parent and appliance context.

Rejection: The exact invocation is routine in normal maintenance or the source appliance cannot be instrumented safely.

Failure: No endpoint process telemetry exists on FMC, or full command lines and parent context are unavailable.

Platform	Decision	Missing evidence
Defender XDR	Hunting query	Target-environment execution and baseline
Splunk	No reliable implementation	Index, sourcetype, extraction, sample event
Chronicle	No reliable implementation	Parser and exact UDM mapping



CONCLUSION AND REFERENCES

Coverage statement and document control.

FINAL

CONCLUSION

Hunting query

Hunts the exact `package_info.pl` invocation used to execute an attacker-crafted `license.tmp` on compromised Cisco Secure FMC appliances.

A result does not prove CVE-2026-20079/CVE-2026-20316 exploitation, root command execution, reverse shell success, Cyclops Blink deployment, or compromise.

MITRE ATT&CK

T1059

References

1. Cisco Talos — Active exploitation of Cisco FMC vulnerabilities (09 Sep 2026)
2. Microsoft Learn — DeviceProcessEvents (updated 07 Aug 2026)
3. Cisco PSIRT — CVE-2026-20079 and CVE-2026-20316 advisories
4. MITRE ATT&CK — T1059

Document control

English dossier. No customer data. URLs are defanged in references.txt. HTML and rendering assets remain private.